

RECIPES

Classic Chicken Saute

Prep Time: 10 min | Cook Time: 20 min | Servings: 4 | Difficulty: Easy

A quick and flavorful pan-cooked chicken dish perfect for weeknight dinners.

Ingredients:

- 500g boneless chicken breast, sliced into strips
- 2 tablespoons olive oil
- 1 medium onion, thinly sliced
- 2 cloves garlic, minced
- 1 red bell pepper, sliced
- 1 green bell pepper, sliced
- 1 teaspoon paprika
- 1/2 teaspoon black pepper
- 1/2 teaspoon salt
- 1/2 teaspoon cumin
- 2 tablespoons soy sauce
- Fresh parsley for garnish

Instructions:

1. Season chicken strips with salt, pepper, paprika, and cumin. Mix well and let rest for 5 minutes.
2. Heat olive oil in a large pan over medium-high heat until shimmering.
3. Add chicken strips in a single layer. Cook for 4-5 minutes without stirring to get a golden sear.
4. Flip the chicken and cook for another 3-4 minutes until cooked through. Remove and set aside.
5. In the same pan, add onion and cook for 2-3 minutes until softened.
6. Add garlic and cook for 30 seconds until fragrant.

7. Add bell peppers and stir-fry for 3-4 minutes until slightly tender but still crisp.

8. Return chicken to the pan, add soy sauce, and toss everything together for 1-2 minutes.

9. Garnish with fresh parsley and serve hot with rice or bread.

Tip: For extra flavor, marinate the chicken in soy sauce and garlic for 30 minutes before cooking.

Creamy Garlic Chicken

Prep Time: 10 min | Cook Time: 25 min | Servings: 4 | Difficulty: Easy

Tender chicken breasts smothered in a rich, garlicky cream sauce.

Ingredients:

- 4 boneless chicken breasts (about 600g)
- 3 tablespoons butter
- 6 cloves garlic, minced
- 1 cup heavy cream
- 1/2 cup chicken broth
- 1 teaspoon Italian seasoning
- 1/2 teaspoon onion powder
- Salt and black pepper to taste
- 1/4 cup grated Parmesan cheese
- Fresh spinach (optional, 1 cup)
- Fresh thyme for garnish

Instructions:

1. Season chicken breasts on both sides with salt, pepper, and onion powder.
2. Melt 2 tablespoons of butter in a large skillet over medium-high heat.
3. Sear chicken breasts for 5-6 minutes per side until golden brown and cooked through. Remove and set aside.
4. Reduce heat to medium. Add remaining butter and minced garlic. Cook for 1 minute until fragrant.

5. Pour in chicken broth and scrape up any browned bits from the bottom of the pan.
6. Add heavy cream and Italian seasoning. Stir to combine.
7. Bring to a gentle simmer and cook for 3-4 minutes until sauce begins to thicken.
8. Stir in Parmesan cheese. If using spinach, add it now and cook until wilted.
9. Return chicken to the pan and spoon sauce over it. Simmer for 2 more minutes.
10. Garnish with fresh thyme and serve immediately with pasta or mashed potatoes.

Tip: If the sauce is too thick, add a splash of chicken broth to reach desired consistency.

Lemon Herb Roasted Chicken

Prep Time: 15 min | Cook Time: 45 min | Servings: 4 | Difficulty: Medium

Juicy roasted chicken with bright lemon flavor and aromatic herbs.

Ingredients:

- 1 whole chicken (1.5 kg) or 4 chicken thighs with skin
- 3 tablespoons olive oil
- 2 lemons (zest and juice of 1, the other sliced)
- 4 cloves garlic, minced
- 1 tablespoon fresh rosemary, chopped
- 1 tablespoon fresh thyme leaves
- 1 tablespoon fresh oregano
- 1 teaspoon salt
- 1/2 teaspoon black pepper
- 1/2 teaspoon paprika
- 1 cup chicken broth

Instructions:

1. Preheat oven to 200 degrees Celsius (400 degrees Fahrenheit).
2. Mix olive oil, lemon zest, lemon juice, garlic, rosemary, thyme, oregano, salt, pepper, and paprika to create a marinade.
3. Pat chicken dry with paper towels. Rub the herb mixture all over the chicken, including under the skin.

4. Place lemon slices inside the cavity and around the chicken in the roasting pan.
5. Pour chicken broth into the bottom of the roasting pan.
6. Roast for 45-50 minutes (for thighs) or 1 hour 15 minutes (for whole chicken), basting every 20 minutes.
7. The chicken is done when juices run clear and internal temperature reaches 75 degrees Celsius.
8. Rest for 10 minutes before carving. Serve with roasted vegetables.

Tip: For crispier skin, pat the chicken very dry before applying the marinade.

Classic Beef Stew

Prep Time: 20 min | Cook Time: 2 hours | Servings: 6 | Difficulty: Medium

A hearty, slow-cooked beef stew with tender vegetables in a rich broth.

Ingredients:

- 800g beef chuck, cut into 3cm cubes
- 3 tablespoons vegetable oil
- 1 large onion, diced
- 3 cloves garlic, minced
- 3 medium carrots, cut into chunks
- 3 medium potatoes, cut into chunks
- 2 celery stalks, sliced
- 2 tablespoons tomato paste
- 1 cup red wine (or extra broth)
- 3 cups beef broth
- 1 bay leaf
- 1 teaspoon thyme
- 2 tablespoons flour
- Salt and pepper to taste

Instructions:

1. Pat beef cubes dry. Season generously with salt and pepper, then dust with flour.

2. Heat oil in a large heavy pot or Dutch oven over high heat.
3. Brown beef in batches for 3-4 minutes per side. Do not overcrowd. Remove and set aside.
4. Reduce heat to medium. Add onion and cook for 3-4 minutes until soft.
5. Add garlic and tomato paste. Cook for 1 minute, stirring constantly.
6. Pour in red wine and scrape up all the browned bits from the bottom.
7. Return beef to pot. Add broth, bay leaf, and thyme.
8. Bring to a boil, then reduce to a low simmer. Cover and cook for 1 hour.
9. Add carrots, potatoes, and celery. Continue simmering for 45 minutes until vegetables are tender.
10. Remove bay leaf. Adjust seasoning and serve hot with crusty bread.

Tip: The longer you simmer, the more tender and flavorful the beef becomes.

Pan-Seared Beef Steak with Mushroom Sauce

Prep Time: 10 min | Cook Time: 20 min | Servings: 2 | Difficulty: Medium

Restaurant-quality steak at home with a luxurious mushroom pan sauce.

Ingredients:

- 2 ribeye or sirloin steaks (about 250g each, 2.5cm thick)
- 2 tablespoons vegetable oil
- 2 tablespoons butter
- 3 cloves garlic, crushed
- 2 sprigs fresh rosemary
- 200g button mushrooms, sliced
- 1 shallot, finely diced
- 1/2 cup beef broth
- 1/4 cup heavy cream
- 1 teaspoon Worcestershire sauce
- Salt and black pepper to taste

Instructions:

1. Take steaks out of the fridge 30 minutes before cooking. Pat dry and season heavily with salt and pepper.
2. Heat a cast iron or heavy skillet over very high heat until smoking.
3. Add oil, then carefully place steaks in the pan.
4. Cook for 3-4 minutes without moving for medium-rare. Flip once.
5. Add butter, garlic, and rosemary. Baste the steaks continuously with the melted butter for 2-3 minutes.
6. Remove steaks and rest on a plate covered loosely with foil for 5 minutes.
7. In the same pan over medium heat, cook shallot for 1 minute.
8. Add mushrooms and cook for 4-5 minutes until golden.
9. Pour in beef broth and Worcestershire sauce. Simmer for 2 minutes.
10. Stir in cream and simmer until sauce thickens slightly. Season and pour over steaks.

Tip: For medium doneness, cook 1-2 minutes longer per side. Always rest steak before cutting.

Slow-Cooked Lamb Shanks

Prep Time: 15 min | Cook Time: 3 hours | Servings: 4 | Difficulty: Medium

Fall-off-the-bone tender lamb shanks braised in a rich tomato and herb sauce.

Ingredients:

- 4 lamb shanks (about 400g each)
- 3 tablespoons olive oil
- 1 large onion, diced
- 4 cloves garlic, minced
- 2 carrots, diced
- 1 can (400g) crushed tomatoes
- 1 cup red wine
- 2 cups beef or lamb broth
- 2 sprigs rosemary

- 3 sprigs thyme
- 1 bay leaf
- Salt and pepper to taste

Instructions:

1. Preheat oven to 160 degrees Celsius (320 Fahrenheit).
2. Season lamb shanks generously with salt and pepper.
3. Heat olive oil in a large oven-safe pot over high heat. Brown shanks on all sides, about 8-10 minutes total. Remove and set aside.
4. Reduce heat to medium. Add onion, garlic, and carrots. Cook for 5 minutes.
5. Pour in red wine. Let it bubble for 2 minutes.
6. Add crushed tomatoes, broth, rosemary, thyme, and bay leaf.
7. Return lamb shanks to the pot. The liquid should come halfway up the shanks.
8. Bring to a simmer, then cover tightly and transfer to the oven.
9. Cook for 2.5 to 3 hours, turning shanks halfway through, until meat is falling off the bone.
10. Remove herbs. Serve shanks over mashed potatoes or polenta with the sauce spooned over.

Tip: This dish tastes even better the next day as flavors develop overnight.

Classic Spaghetti Bolognese

Prep Time: 15 min | Cook Time: 45 min | Servings: 4 | Difficulty: Easy

A rich, meaty Italian tomato sauce served over perfectly cooked spaghetti.

Ingredients:

- 400g spaghetti
- 500g ground beef
- 1 large onion, finely diced
- 3 cloves garlic, minced
- 2 carrots, finely diced
- 2 celery stalks, finely diced

- 1 can (400g) crushed tomatoes
- 2 tablespoons tomato paste
- 1/2 cup red wine or beef broth
- 1 teaspoon dried oregano
- 1 teaspoon dried basil
- 2 tablespoons olive oil
- Salt and pepper to taste
- Parmesan cheese for serving

Instructions:

1. Heat olive oil in a large saucepan over medium heat.
2. Add onion, carrot, and celery. Cook for 5-6 minutes until softened.
3. Add garlic and cook for 30 seconds.
4. Increase heat to high. Add ground beef and break it up with a spoon.
5. Cook for 6-8 minutes until beef is browned and any liquid has evaporated.
6. Add tomato paste and cook for 1 minute.
7. Pour in wine or broth and let it reduce for 2 minutes.
8. Add crushed tomatoes, oregano, basil, salt, and pepper.
9. Reduce heat to low and simmer uncovered for 30 minutes, stirring occasionally.
10. Cook spaghetti according to package instructions. Reserve 1/2 cup pasta water.
11. Toss spaghetti with sauce, adding pasta water if needed. Serve with Parmesan.

Tip: The longer the sauce simmers, the richer and deeper the flavor becomes.

Creamy Mushroom Risotto

Prep Time: 10 min | Cook Time: 35 min | Servings: 4 | Difficulty: Medium

Velvety Italian risotto loaded with earthy mushrooms and Parmesan.

Ingredients:

- 320g Arborio rice
- 300g mixed mushrooms (button, cremini, shiitake), sliced

- 1 medium onion, finely diced
- 3 cloves garlic, minced
- 1/2 cup dry white wine
- 1 liter warm chicken or vegetable broth
- 3 tablespoons butter
- 2 tablespoons olive oil
- 1/2 cup grated Parmesan cheese
- Fresh thyme leaves
- Salt and pepper to taste

Instructions:

1. Keep broth warm in a separate saucepan over low heat.
2. In a large pan, heat 1 tablespoon butter and olive oil over medium-high heat.
3. Add mushrooms and cook for 5-6 minutes without stirring until golden. Season and set aside.
4. In the same pan, melt 1 tablespoon butter over medium heat. Add onion and cook for 3 minutes.
5. Add garlic and Arborio rice. Stir for 1-2 minutes to toast the rice.
6. Pour in white wine. Stir until fully absorbed.
7. Add warm broth one ladle at a time, stirring constantly and waiting until each ladle is absorbed before adding the next.
8. Continue this process for about 20-22 minutes until rice is creamy but still has a slight bite (al dente).
9. Remove from heat. Stir in remaining butter and Parmesan cheese.
10. Fold in the cooked mushrooms. Season to taste. Garnish with thyme and serve immediately.

Tip: Never stop stirring risotto! The constant movement releases starch and creates the creamy texture.

One-Pan Lemon Garlic Shrimp Pasta

Prep Time: 10 min | Cook Time: 20 min | Servings: 4 | Difficulty: Easy

A bright and zesty pasta dish made entirely in one pan for minimal cleanup.

Ingredients:

- 400g linguine or spaghetti
- 400g large shrimp, peeled and deveined
- 4 tablespoons olive oil
- 6 cloves garlic, sliced
- 1/2 teaspoon red pepper flakes
- Zest and juice of 2 lemons
- 1/2 cup white wine or chicken broth
- 3 tablespoons butter
- 1/4 cup fresh parsley, chopped
- Salt and black pepper to taste
- Parmesan for serving

Instructions:

1. Cook pasta according to package instructions until al dente. Reserve 1 cup pasta water. Drain.
2. Season shrimp with salt, pepper, and a pinch of red pepper flakes.
3. Heat 2 tablespoons olive oil in a large pan over high heat.
4. Add shrimp in a single layer. Cook 1-2 minutes per side until pink. Remove and set aside.
5. Reduce heat to medium. Add remaining oil and sliced garlic.
6. Cook garlic for 1-2 minutes until golden (do not burn).
7. Add red pepper flakes, then pour in wine. Let it bubble for 1 minute.
8. Add lemon juice, zest, and butter. Stir until butter melts.
9. Add cooked pasta and toss to coat, adding pasta water as needed.
10. Return shrimp to pan. Toss with fresh parsley. Serve with Parmesan.

Tip: Do not overcook shrimp — they become rubbery. Remove from heat as soon as they turn pink.

Spiced Red Lentil Soup

Prep Time: 10 min | Cook Time: 30 min | Servings: 6 | Difficulty: Easy

A warming, protein-rich soup with aromatic Middle Eastern spices.

Ingredients:

- 300g red lentils, rinsed
- 1 large onion, diced
- 4 cloves garlic, minced
- 2 medium tomatoes, diced
- 2 medium carrots, diced
- 1.5 liters vegetable broth
- 2 tablespoons olive oil
- 1 teaspoon ground cumin
- 1 teaspoon ground coriander
- 1/2 teaspoon turmeric
- 1/2 teaspoon paprika
- 1/4 teaspoon cayenne pepper
- Juice of 1 lemon
- Salt and pepper to taste
- Fresh cilantro or parsley for garnish

Instructions:

1. Heat olive oil in a large pot over medium heat.
2. Add onion and cook for 4-5 minutes until softened and lightly golden.
3. Add garlic and all spices (cumin, coriander, turmeric, paprika, cayenne). Cook for 1 minute.
4. Add tomatoes and cook for 2-3 minutes until they begin to break down.
5. Add carrots and lentils. Stir to combine with the spiced base.
6. Pour in vegetable broth. Bring to a boil.
7. Reduce heat and simmer uncovered for 20-25 minutes until lentils are completely soft.

8. Use an immersion blender to partially blend the soup for a creamy texture, or blend all of it for a smooth soup.

9. Add lemon juice. Season with salt and pepper.

10. Serve hot garnished with fresh herbs and a drizzle of olive oil.

Tip: Red lentils dissolve naturally as they cook, so no soaking is needed. They are ready when completely soft.

Roasted Vegetable Quinoa Bowl

Prep Time: 15 min | Cook Time: 30 min | Servings: 4 | Difficulty: Easy

A nutritious and colorful bowl packed with roasted vegetables and fluffy quinoa.

Ingredients:

- 200g quinoa, rinsed
- 1 zucchini, diced
- 1 red bell pepper, diced
- 1 yellow bell pepper, diced
- 1 red onion, diced
- 200g cherry tomatoes
- 200g chickpeas, drained and rinsed
- 3 tablespoons olive oil
- 1 teaspoon cumin
- 1 teaspoon paprika
- Salt and pepper to taste
- For dressing: 3 tbsp tahini, 2 tbsp lemon juice, 1 clove garlic minced, 3 tbsp water
- Fresh parsley and feta cheese for topping

Instructions:

1. Preheat oven to 220 degrees Celsius (425 Fahrenheit). Line a large baking sheet with parchment.
2. Toss all vegetables and chickpeas with olive oil, cumin, paprika, salt, and pepper.

3. Spread in a single layer on the baking sheet. Roast for 25-30 minutes until caramelized.
4. Meanwhile, cook quinoa: combine with 400ml water in a saucepan. Bring to a boil.
5. Cover and reduce heat to low. Cook for 15 minutes until water is absorbed. Fluff with a fork.
6. Make tahini dressing: whisk together tahini, lemon juice, garlic, and water until smooth.
7. Divide quinoa between bowls. Top with roasted vegetables.
8. Drizzle with tahini dressing. Top with crumbled feta and fresh parsley.

Tip: Spread vegetables in a single layer with space between them. Crowding causes steaming instead of roasting.

Paneer Butter Masala

Prep Time: 15 min | Cook Time: 30 min | Servings: 4 | Difficulty: Medium

Creamy, restaurant-style Indian curry with soft paneer cubes in a rich tomato sauce.

Ingredients:

- 400g paneer, cut into cubes
- 2 tablespoons butter
- 1 tablespoon oil
- 1 large onion, diced
- 4 cloves garlic, minced
- 1 tablespoon fresh ginger, grated
- 1 can (400g) crushed tomatoes
- 1/2 cup heavy cream
- 1 teaspoon garam masala
- 1 teaspoon cumin
- 1 teaspoon coriander powder
- 1/2 teaspoon turmeric
- 1 teaspoon paprika or Kashmiri chili

- Salt to taste
- Fresh cilantro for garnish

Instructions:

1. Heat 1 tablespoon oil in a pan over medium-high heat. Fry paneer cubes until golden on each side. Remove and set aside.
2. In the same pan, melt butter over medium heat. Add onion and cook for 5-6 minutes until golden.
3. Add garlic and ginger. Cook for 1 minute until fragrant.
4. Add all spices (garam masala, cumin, coriander, turmeric, paprika). Stir for 30 seconds.
5. Add crushed tomatoes. Cook for 8-10 minutes, stirring often, until sauce thickens and oil separates.
6. Let mixture cool slightly, then blend until smooth.
7. Return blended sauce to pan over low heat. Stir in heavy cream.
8. Add fried paneer cubes. Simmer for 5 minutes.
9. Season with salt. Garnish with cilantro. Serve with naan or rice.

Tip: Frying the paneer first gives it a golden crust that holds its shape in the curry without falling apart.

Classic Caesar Salad

Prep Time: 15 min | Cook Time: 10 min | Servings: 4 | Difficulty: Easy

Crisp romaine lettuce with a creamy homemade Caesar dressing and crunchy croutons.

Ingredients:

- 2 large romaine lettuce heads, chopped
- 1/2 cup grated Parmesan cheese
- For croutons: 4 slices bread, 2 tbsp olive oil, 1 clove garlic, salt
- For dressing: 3 tbsp mayonnaise, 2 tsp Dijon mustard, 2 tsp Worcestershire sauce
- 2 cloves garlic (for dressing), minced
- Juice of 1 lemon
- 1/4 cup olive oil

- Salt and black pepper to taste

Instructions:

1. Make croutons: cube bread and toss with olive oil, minced garlic, and salt.
2. Bake at 190 degrees Celsius for 10-12 minutes until golden and crispy. Let cool.
3. Make dressing: whisk together mayonnaise, Dijon mustard, Worcestershire sauce, garlic, and lemon juice.
4. Slowly drizzle in olive oil while whisking constantly until emulsified.
5. Season dressing with salt and pepper. Taste and adjust.
6. In a large bowl, toss chopped romaine with dressing until evenly coated.
7. Add croutons and half the Parmesan. Toss gently.
8. Serve immediately with remaining Parmesan on top.

Tip: Dress the salad right before serving to keep the lettuce crisp and fresh.

French Onion Soup

Prep Time: 10 min | Cook Time: 1 hour | Servings: 4 | Difficulty: Medium

Sweet caramelized onions in a rich broth, topped with toasted bread and melted Gruyere.

Ingredients:

- 1.2 kg onions, thinly sliced
- 4 tablespoons butter
- 1 tablespoon olive oil
- 1 teaspoon sugar
- 3 cloves garlic, minced
- 1/2 cup dry white wine
- 1.5 liters beef broth
- 1 bay leaf
- 1 teaspoon thyme
- Salt and pepper to taste
- 4 thick slices baguette

- 150g Gruyere cheese, grated

Instructions:

1. Melt butter and olive oil in a large pot over medium heat.
2. Add all the sliced onions and sugar. Stir to coat with butter.
3. Cook onions over medium-low heat for 45-50 minutes, stirring every 5-10 minutes, until deeply caramelized and golden brown.
4. Add garlic and cook for 1 minute.
5. Pour in white wine and scrape up any browned bits. Cook for 2 minutes.
6. Add broth, bay leaf, and thyme. Bring to a boil, then simmer for 15 minutes.
7. Remove bay leaf. Season with salt and pepper.
8. Toast baguette slices until crispy.
9. Ladle soup into oven-safe bowls. Place a bread slice on top. Cover generously with Gruyere.
10. Broil for 3-4 minutes until cheese is bubbly and golden. Serve immediately.

Tip: Patience is key. Do not rush the caramelization. The deep color and sweet flavor take at least 45 minutes.

Classic Omelette

Prep Time: 5 min | Cook Time: 5 min | Servings: 1 | Difficulty: Easy

A perfectly folded French-style omelette — simple, fast, and endlessly versatile.

Ingredients:

- 3 large eggs
- 1 tablespoon butter
- 2 tablespoons milk or cream
- Salt and pepper to taste
- Optional fillings: shredded cheese, diced ham, sauteed mushrooms, fresh herbs

Instructions

1. Crack eggs into a bowl. Add milk, salt, and pepper. Beat well with a fork until fully combined.

2. Heat a non-stick pan (20cm) over medium-high heat.
3. Add butter and swirl to coat the pan. When it foams and starts to brown, add the egg mixture.
4. Immediately shake the pan and use a spatula to pull the cooked edges toward the center.
5. When the eggs are mostly set but still slightly glossy on top (about 1 minute), add any fillings to one half.
6. Tilt the pan and fold the omelette in half over the fillings.
7. Slide onto a plate and serve immediately.

Tip: The pan must be hot enough for the eggs to set quickly, creating a smooth exterior without browning.

Avocado Toast with Poached Egg

Prep Time: 10 min | Cook Time: 5 min | Servings: 2 | Difficulty: Easy

The ultimate quick meal: creamy avocado on toasted bread crowned with a perfectly poached egg.

Ingredients:

- 2 slices thick sourdough or whole grain bread
- 2 ripe avocados
- 2 eggs
- 1 tablespoon white vinegar (for poaching)
- Juice of half a lemon
- Red pepper flakes
- Salt and black pepper
- Olive oil for drizzling
- Optional: feta cheese, cherry tomatoes, microgreens

Instructions:

1. Toast bread until golden and crispy.
2. Halve and pit avocados. Scoop flesh into a bowl.
3. Mash avocado with lemon juice, salt, and pepper. Leave slightly chunky.

4. Bring a saucepan of water to a gentle simmer. Add white vinegar.
 5. Crack an egg into a small cup. Create a gentle swirl in the water.
 6. Slide egg into the center of the swirl. Cook for 3 minutes for a runny yolk.
 7. Remove with a slotted spoon. Pat dry.
 8. Spread avocado on toast. Top with poached egg.
 9. Sprinkle with red pepper flakes, salt, and a drizzle of olive oil. Serve immediately.
- Tip:** Use the freshest eggs possible for poaching. The whites hold together much better.

Lentil Soup

Prep Time: 10 min | Cook Time: 30 min | Servings: 4 | Difficulty: Easy

A protein-rich and comforting red lentil soup.

Ingredients:

- 1 cup red lentils, rinsed
- 1 medium onion, diced
- 1 medium carrot, grated
- 1 tablespoon tomato paste
- 6 cups water or chicken broth
- 2 tablespoons olive oil
- 1 teaspoon salt
- 1/2 teaspoon black pepper
- 1/2 teaspoon red pepper flakes
- Lemon wedges and fresh parsley for serving

Instructions:

1. Heat olive oil in a pot, sauté onion and carrot for 3-4 minutes.
2. Add tomato paste and cook 1 minute.
3. Stir in lentils and water. Bring to a boil.
4. Reduce heat and simmer 20 minutes until lentils are soft.
5. Blend partially or fully for a smooth texture. Season with salt and spices.
6. Serve hot with lemon and parsley.

Kuru Fasulye

Prep Time: 15 min | Cook Time: 1.5 hours | Servings: 6 | Difficulty: Medium

Classic Turkish white bean stew with rich flavors.

Ingredients:

- 2 cups dried white beans, soaked overnight
- 1 large onion, chopped
- 2 tablespoons tomato paste
- 3 tablespoons olive oil
- 6 cups water
- 1 teaspoon salt
- 1/2 teaspoon black pepper
- 1 teaspoon paprika

Instructions:

1. Drain beans. Heat oil, sauté onion and add tomato paste.
2. Add beans and water, bring to a boil.
3. Simmer on low for 1–1.5 hours until beans are tender.
4. Season with salt and pepper. Serve warm.

Stuffed Peppers (Biber Dolması)

Prep Time: 20 min | Cook Time: 40 min | Servings: 4 | Difficulty: Medium

Peppers stuffed with a savory rice mixture.

Ingredients:

- 6 medium bell peppers
- 1 cup rice, rinsed
- 1 medium onion, diced
- 2 tablespoons tomato paste
- 1/2 cup olive oil
- 1 teaspoon salt
- 1/2 teaspoon black pepper
- 1 teaspoon dried mint
- 1/2 cup water

Instructions:

1. Sauté onion in olive oil, add tomato paste and rice, cook 2 minutes.
2. Mix in spices and water, cook 5 minutes.

3. Fill peppers with rice mixture, place in pot, cover with water.
4. Simmer 30 minutes until peppers are tender.
5. Serve warm or at room temperature.

Meatballs with Potatoes

Prep Time: 15 min | Cook Time: 30 min | Servings: 4 | Difficulty: Easy

Juicy meatballs baked with golden potatoes.

Ingredients:

- 500g ground beef
- 1 small onion, grated
- 1 slice stale bread, soaked and squeezed
- 1 egg
- Salt, pepper, cumin
- 4 medium potatoes, sliced
- 2 tablespoons olive oil

Instructions:

1. Mix beef, onion, bread, egg, and spices; shape into meatballs.
2. Arrange potatoes on a baking tray, drizzle with oil.
3. Place meatballs on top.
4. Bake at 200°C (400°F) for 25–30 minutes.
5. Serve hot.

Turkish Dumplings (Manti)

Prep Time: 30 min | Cook Time: 25 min | Servings: 4 | Difficulty: Medium

Small dough parcels filled with spiced meat, served with yogurt.

Ingredients:

- 2 cups flour
- 1/2 cup water
- 1 egg
- 200g ground beef
- 1 small onion, grated
- Salt and pepper
- Yogurt and melted butter sauce

Instructions:

1. Knead dough, rest 30 minutes.
2. Mix beef with onion and spices.
3. Roll dough, cut into small squares, fill with meat, fold into dumplings.
4. Boil 8–10 minutes.
5. Serve with yogurt and butter sauce.

Imam Bayildi

Prep Time: 20 min | Cook Time: 40 min | Servings: 4 | Difficulty: Medium

Eggplants stuffed with onion, garlic, and tomato, cooked in olive oil.

Ingredients:

- 4 medium eggplants
- 2 onions, thinly sliced
- 3 tomatoes, grated
- 3 cloves garlic, minced
- 1/4 cup olive oil
- Salt and pepper

Instructions:

1. Roast or fry eggplants.
2. Sauté onions and garlic in olive oil, add tomatoes, cook 5 minutes.
3. Arrange eggplants in pot, pour sauce over.
4. Simmer 15–20 minutes.
5. Serve warm or room temperature.

Chicken Sauté (Tavuk Sote)

Prep Time: 10 min | Cook Time: 20 min | Servings: 4 | Difficulty: Easy

Quick chicken sauté with colorful bell peppers.

Ingredients:

- 500g chicken breast, sliced
- 1 red bell pepper, sliced
- 1 green bell pepper, sliced
- 1 medium onion, sliced

- 2 tablespoons olive oil
- Salt, black pepper, paprika

Instructions:

1. Season chicken with salt and pepper.
2. Heat oil, cook chicken 5–6 minutes.
3. Add vegetables, cook 4–5 minutes.
4. Serve hot.

Lahmacun

Prep Time: 20 min | Cook Time: 15 min | Servings: 4 | Difficulty: Medium

Thin flatbread topped with spiced ground meat.

Ingredients:

- 250g ground beef or lamb
- 1 onion, finely diced
- 1 tomato, finely diced
- 1 tablespoon tomato paste
- 1 teaspoon paprika
- 1 teaspoon salt
- 4 flatbreads or dough rounds

Instructions:

1. Mix meat with vegetables, tomato paste, and spices.
2. Spread over flatbreads.
3. Bake at 220°C (425°F) for 12–15 minutes.
4. Serve hot with lemon and parsley.

Su Böreği

Prep Time: 30 min | Cook Time: 30 min | Servings: 6 | Difficulty: Medium

Layered pastry with cheese and butter, a Turkish classic.

Ingredients:

- 6 sheets phyllo dough
- 400g feta cheese
- 2 eggs
- 1/2 cup butter, melted

- 1/4 cup milk
- Fresh parsley, chopped

Instructions:

1. Layer phyllo sheets in a baking tray, brushing with butter.
2. Mix feta with eggs, spread over layers.
3. Top with remaining phyllo sheets, bake at 180°C (350°F) 30 minutes.
4. Serve warm.

Kuymak (Cornmeal & Cheese)

Prep Time: 5 min | Cook Time: 15 min | Servings: 4 | Difficulty: Easy

Melty Turkish cornmeal and cheese dish, perfect for breakfast.

Ingredients:

- 1 cup cornmeal
- 2 cups water
- 150g Turkish cheese (kaşar or mozzarella)
- 2 tablespoons butter
- Salt to taste

Instructions:

1. Melt butter in a pan, add cornmeal, stir 2 minutes.
2. Gradually add water, stirring to avoid lumps.
3. Add cheese, cook until melted and creamy.
4. Serve hot with bread.

Stuffed Grape Leaves (Zeytinyağlı Yaprak Sarma)

Prep Time: 30 min | Cook Time: 1 hour | Servings: 6 | Difficulty: Medium

Tender grape leaves stuffed with a flavorful rice and herb mixture, cooked in olive oil.

Ingredients:

- 300g grape leaves, rinsed and blanched
- 1 cup rice, rinsed
- 1 medium onion, finely diced
- 1/2 cup olive oil
- 1/4 cup pine nuts (optional)
- 2 tablespoons currants (optional)

- 1 teaspoon salt
- 1/2 teaspoon black pepper
- 1 teaspoon allspice
- 1 tablespoon fresh dill, chopped
- 2 tablespoons tomato paste
- Juice of 1 lemon
- 2 cups water

Instructions:

1. Heat half the olive oil in a pan, sauté onion until soft.
2. Add rice, pine nuts, currants, tomato paste, herbs, and spices. Stir for 3–4 minutes.
3. Add 1 cup water and cook until rice is half done, about 10 minutes.
4. Remove from heat, let mixture cool slightly.
5. Place a teaspoon of filling on each grape leaf and roll tightly.
6. Arrange rolls in a pot, seam side down, stacking tightly.
7. Pour remaining water, olive oil, and lemon juice over the rolls.
8. Cover and simmer gently for 40–50 minutes.
9. Serve warm or at room temperature, drizzled with extra olive oil.

Tip: Make sure to pack the rolls tightly in the pot to prevent them from unrolling during cooking.

Turkish Borek (Börek)

Prep Time: 20 min | Cook Time: 35 min | Servings: 6 | Difficulty: Medium

Flaky pastry filled with cheese, spinach, or minced meat.

Ingredients:

- 6 sheets phyllo dough
- 200g feta cheese, crumbled
- 1 cup fresh spinach, chopped (optional)
- 1 egg
- 1/2 cup butter, melted
- 1/4 cup milk
- Salt and pepper to taste

Instructions:

1. Preheat oven to 180°C (350°F).
2. Brush a baking dish with butter. Layer phyllo sheets, brushing each with butter.
3. Mix feta, spinach, and egg; season with salt and pepper.
4. Spread filling over phyllo layers, cover with remaining sheets.
5. Bake 30–35 minutes until golden and crispy.
6. Slice and serve warm.

Tip: Keep phyllo sheets covered with a damp cloth to prevent drying out while assembling.

Chicken Casserole (Tavuk Güveç)

Prep Time: 15 min | Cook Time: 1 hour | Servings: 4 | Difficulty: Medium

A comforting oven-baked chicken stew with vegetables and tomato sauce.

Ingredients:

- 500g chicken thighs, skinless and bone-in
- 1 onion, diced
- 2 carrots, sliced
- 2 potatoes, cubed
- 2 bell peppers, sliced
- 2 tomatoes, diced
- 2 tablespoons tomato paste
- 1/4 cup olive oil
- 1 teaspoon paprika
- 1 teaspoon salt
- 1/2 teaspoon black pepper
- 1/2 teaspoon oregano
- 1/2 cup water or chicken broth

Instructions:

1. Preheat oven to 180°C (350°F).
2. Heat olive oil in a skillet, lightly brown chicken on both sides.
3. Transfer chicken to a casserole dish, add vegetables.
4. Mix tomato paste, water, and spices; pour over chicken and vegetables.
5. Cover with foil and bake 50–60 minutes until chicken and vegetables are tender.

6. Remove foil, bake 10 more minutes to slightly brown top.

Tip: Add a splash of lemon juice before serving for a bright, fresh flavor.

Stuffed Eggplant (Karniyarik)

Prep Time: 25 min | Cook Time: 45 min | Servings: 4 | Difficulty: Medium

Eggplants stuffed with a savory ground meat mixture and baked in tomato sauce.

Ingredients:

- 4 medium eggplants
- 300g ground beef or lamb
- 1 onion, diced
- 2 tomatoes, diced
- 2 cloves garlic, minced
- 2 tablespoons tomato paste
- 1/4 cup olive oil
- Salt and black pepper

Instructions:

1. Slice eggplants lengthwise and lightly fry or roast until soft.
2. Sauté onion, garlic, and meat until browned. Add tomato paste and diced tomatoes, cook 5 minutes.
3. Fill eggplants with meat mixture, place in baking dish.
4. Bake at 180°C (350°F) for 25–30 minutes.
5. Serve hot with rice.

Tip: For richer flavor, brush eggplants with olive oil before baking.

Eggplant Moussaka (Patlıcan Musakka)

Prep Time: 20 min | Cook Time: 45 min | Servings: 4 | Difficulty: Medium

Layered eggplant, minced meat, and tomato sauce, baked until golden.

Ingredients:

- 2 large eggplants, sliced
- 300g ground beef
- 1 onion, diced
- 2 tomatoes, chopped
- 2 tablespoons tomato paste
- 1/4 cup olive oil
- Salt, pepper, paprika

Instructions:

1. Fry or bake eggplant slices until lightly golden.
2. Cook onion and meat, add tomato paste, tomatoes, and spices.
3. Layer eggplants and meat mixture in a baking dish.
4. Bake at 180°C (350°F) for 25–30 minutes.
5. Serve warm.

Tip: Let moussaka rest 10 minutes before slicing for clean layers.

Pilav

Prep Time: 5 min | Cook Time: 20 min | Servings: 4 | Difficulty: Easy

Classic Turkish rice pilaf with a light buttery flavor.

Ingredients:

- 1 cup long-grain rice, rinsed
- 2 tablespoons butter or olive oil
- 2 cups water or broth
- 1 teaspoon salt

Instructions:

1. Melt butter in a pot, sauté rice 2–3 minutes until lightly golden.
2. Add water and salt, bring to boil.
3. Cover, reduce heat, simmer 15 minutes.
4. Remove from heat, let stand 5 minutes, fluff with fork.

Tip: Toasting rice lightly before boiling gives a nutty aroma.

Iskender Kebab

Prep Time: 20 min | Cook Time: 15 min | Servings: 4 | Difficulty: Medium

Thinly sliced lamb or beef served over bread with tomato sauce and yogurt.

Ingredients:

- 500g doner-style lamb or beef slices
- 2 pita or pide breads, cut into cubes
- 2 tablespoons butter
- 2 tomatoes, blended or pureed
- 1 teaspoon paprika

- 1 cup yogurt
- Salt to taste

Instructions:

1. Heat tomato sauce with paprika and salt.
2. Melt butter in skillet.
3. Layer bread cubes on a plate, pour tomato sauce over.
4. Top with meat slices, drizzle with melted butter, serve with yogurt.

Tip: Use freshly baked bread for the best texture.

Poached Eggs with Yogurt (Çılbır)

Prep Time: 10 min | Cook Time: 5 min | Servings: 2 | Difficulty: Easy

Simple Turkish breakfast of poached eggs over garlicky yogurt.

Ingredients:

- 2 eggs
- 1 cup yogurt
- 1 clove garlic, minced
- 1 tablespoon butter
- 1/2 teaspoon paprika
- Salt

Instructions:

1. Mix garlic into yogurt, season with salt.
2. Poach eggs in simmering water 3 minutes for runny yolk.
3. Melt butter, add paprika.
4. Serve eggs over yogurt, drizzle with paprika butter.

Tip: Use fresh eggs for perfect poaching.

Lentil Patties (Mercimek Köftesi)

Prep Time: 20 min | Cook Time: 15 min | Servings: 6 | Difficulty: Easy

Protein-rich red lentil patties flavored with spices and herbs.

Ingredients:

- 1 cup red lentils
- 1/2 cup fine bulgur
- 1 onion, finely chopped

- 1/4 cup olive oil
- 1 tablespoon tomato paste
- 1 teaspoon paprika
- 1 teaspoon cumin
- 2 tablespoons parsley, chopped
- Salt and pepper

Instructions:

1. Boil lentils 10 minutes until soft, add bulgur, let absorb water.
2. Sauté onion with olive oil and tomato paste, mix into lentils.
3. Add spices and parsley.
4. Shape into small patties, serve cold or room temperature.

Tip: Chill the mixture before shaping for easier handling.

Tray Kebab (Tepsi Kebabi)

Prep Time: 15 min | Cook Time: 35 min | Servings: 4 | Difficulty: Medium

Juicy minced meat and vegetables baked on a tray for an easy, flavorful meal.

Ingredients:

- 500g ground beef or lamb
- 2 onions, grated
- 2 tomatoes, sliced
- 2 green peppers, sliced
- 2 tablespoons tomato paste
- 1/4 cup olive oil
- Salt, pepper, paprika

Instructions:

1. Preheat oven to 180°C (350°F).
2. Mix meat, onions, salt, pepper, and paprika.
3. Spread mixture evenly on a baking tray, top with vegetables and tomato paste.
4. Bake 30–35 minutes until cooked through.
5. Serve with rice or flatbread.

Tip: Press the meat mixture evenly on the tray to ensure uniform cooking.